

IN THE UNITED STATES DISTRICT COURT
NORTHERN DISTRICT OF FLORIDA
PENSACOLA DIVISION

DEBRA NELSON

Plaintiff,

v.

Amentum Government Services Parent
Holdings LLC,
CLARENCE XANDER, JANICE HUGHES,
HEATHER GUNN, DAKOTA THOMAS,
ELIAS VALASQUEZ, and
YUSEF ABDUL-JAMI,

Defendants,

C.A. No.: 3:25cv 01447-MCR-ZCB

COMPLAINT AND DEMAND FOR JURY TRIAL

JURISDICTION AND VENUE

1. This is an action for damages and equitable relief under Title VII of the Civil Rights Act of 1964, 42 U.S.C. §2000e et seq., the Florida Whistleblower Act, and Florida common law.
2. This Court has subject matter jurisdiction pursuant to 28 U.S.C. §1331 (federal question) and supplemental jurisdiction over the state law claims pursuant to 28 U.S.C. §1367.
3. Venue is proper in the Northern District of Florida, Pensacola Division, under 28 U.S.C. §1391(b), as the events giving rise to these claims occurred in Santa Rosa County, Florida.

FILED USDC FLND PN
AUG 26 '25 PM 1:08 MB

PARTIES

4. **Plaintiff DEBRA NELSON** is a resident of Florida and was employed by Defendants as an NDI Technician at NAS Whiting Field in Santa Rosa County, Florida.
5. **Defendant AMENTUM GOVERNMENT SERVICES PARENT HOLDINGS LLC** is a Foreign Limited Liability Company registered to do business in Florida, with its Registered Agent being C T Corporation System, 1200 South Pine Island Road, Plantation, FL 33324. Its sole member is Amentum Holdings LLC, located at 4800 Westfields Blvd, Suite 400, Chantilly, VA 20151.
6. **Defendant CLARENCE XANDER** was at all relevant times the Site Manager for Amentum at NAS Whiting Field.
7. **Defendant JANICE HUGHES** was at all relevant times the Human Resources representative for Amentum at NAS Whiting Field.
8. **Defendant HEATHER GUNN** was at all relevant times the Business Manager for Amentum at NAS Whiting Field.
9. **Defendant DAKOTA THOMAS** was at all relevant times a Maintenance Supervisor for Amentum at NAS Whiting Field.
10. **Defendant ELIAS VALASQUEZ** was at all relevant times a Maintenance Supervisor for Amentum at NAS Whiting Field.
11. **Defendant YUSEF ABDUL-JAMI** was at all relevant times an NDI Technician for Amentum at NAS Whiting Field.

FACTUAL ALLEGATIONS

12. Plaintiff began employment with Amentum as an NDI Technician and consistently performed her duties in a satisfactory manner.
13. On March 27, 2025, during a program NDI audit, Plaintiff reported necessary audit corrections to her supervisor, Val Stephens, which were addressed.
14. Shortly after the audit, Plaintiff complained that her male coworker, Defendant Yusef Abdul-Jami, refused to assist her with a job-related locker issue. Plaintiff documented this refusal in text messages and provided them to management.
15. From November 2024 to May 2025, Plaintiff reported repeated noncompliance with process controls before fluorescent penetrant inspections by Defendant Abdul-Jami. These violations risked FAA sanctions and contractual penalties. Management ignored

her reports, protected Abdul-Jami, and began labeling her “aggressive” and as having an “attitude.”

16. On or about May 29, 2025, during a work meeting, Defendant Elias Valasquez cursed at Plaintiff. She was later falsely accused of responding with “Who the fuck do you think you are,” a phrase she never used. Plaintiff was kept uninformed of the allegation from May 29 to August 4, 2025. Corporate only disclosed the claim on August 5, 2025.

17. On August 6, 2025 — the day after Plaintiff informed corporate management she intended to sue — Defendant Dakota Thomas issued a Written Reprimand alleging “unauthorized leave” for July 31 and August 1, 2025. Plaintiff requested additional unpaid bereavement leave via email to Payroll Specialist Tionne Thomas on July 15, 2025, and received confirmation of receipt. (See Exhibit E). This documented request directly refutes the false claim in the August 6, 2025 Written Reprimand that Plaintiff took unauthorized leave.

18. The reprimand falsely claimed that Plaintiff told Defendant Elias Valasquez her leave was approved by HR and the Business Manager. In reality, Plaintiff informed Valasquez that she did not have enough accrued time to cover both days. Valasquez approved the leave for the hours Plaintiff had and instructed her to go upstairs to obtain approval for unpaid leave for the remainder.

19. The reprimand also alleged Plaintiff was absent without calling in, yet no one from Supervision contacted her on that day — indicating a deliberate setup.

20. Plaintiff immediately submitted a written rebuttal, refuting the false statements, documenting prior occasions of unpaid leave without HR approval, and identifying the retaliatory nature of the discipline.

21. As a result of Defendants’ actions, Plaintiff was forced to take two separate 30-day leaves of absence, resulting in significant lost wages and emotional distress.

22. On August 13, 2025, Plaintiff received a letter from Janice Hughes, Human Resources, regarding Plaintiff’s ongoing medical leave. The letter stated that if The Hartford denied Plaintiff’s short-term disability claim, the leave would be retroactively deemed “unauthorized” and subject to discipline. Plaintiff contends that this threatening and coercive communication constituted further retaliation in violation of Title VII, the Florida Whistleblower Act, and common law protections, and created additional emotional distress. The letter is attached hereto as **Exhibit F**.

COUNT I – GENDER DISCRIMINATION (TITLE VII)

Plaintiff was subjected to disparate treatment based on her gender, including being denied assistance, disciplined under false pretenses, and targeted for reporting misconduct.

COUNT II – RETALIATION (TITLE VII)

Plaintiff engaged in protected activity by reporting workplace misconduct and safety violations, and Defendants retaliated through fabricated allegations and adverse employment actions.

COUNT III – HOSTILE WORK ENVIRONMENT (TITLE VII)

Defendants' ongoing harassment, false accusations, and refusal to address misconduct created a workplace permeated with intimidation and hostility.

COUNT IV – WHISTLEBLOWER RETALIATION (FLORIDA WHISTLEBLOWER ACT)

Plaintiff's reports of FAA compliance violations were protected activity under Florida law, and Defendants retaliated by issuing false discipline and fostering a hostile work environment.

COUNT V – DEFAMATION (FLORIDA COMMON LAW)

Defendants published false statements about Plaintiff's conduct to others in the workplace, harming her reputation.

COUNT VI – NEGLIGENT SUPERVISION (FLORIDA COMMON LAW)

Defendants failed to supervise employees who engaged in harassment and retaliation against Plaintiff.

COUNT VII – CIVIL CONSPIRACY (FLORIDA COMMON LAW)

Defendants acted in concert to fabricate disciplinary actions and protect a male coworker from accountability.

DAMAGES

Plaintiff has suffered lost wages, emotional distress, reputational harm, and other compensatory damages. Lost wages include:

- First 30-day leave (May 30 – July 2, 2025) at \$44.66/hour × 160 hours = **\$7,145.60**
- Second 30-day leave (August 9 – September 19, 2025) at \$45.46/hour × 160 hours = **\$7,273.60**

Total wage loss to date: **\$14,419.20** (excluding lost overtime, benefits, and retirement contributions)

Plaintiff also seeks punitive damages under Title VII and Florida law, as well as attorney's

fees and costs.

PRAYER FOR RELIEF

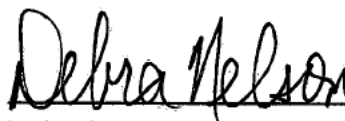
WHEREFORE, Plaintiff respectfully requests that this Court enter judgment in her favor and against Defendants for:

- a. Back pay, front pay, and lost benefits;
- b. Compensatory damages for emotional distress and reputational harm;
- c. Punitive damages as allowed by law;
- d. Attorney's fees and costs;
- e. Pre- and post-judgment interest; and
- f. All other relief this Court deems just and proper.

JURY DEMAND

Plaintiff demands trial by jury on all issues so triable.

Respectfully submitted 26th of August, 2025,



Debra Nelson

Plaintiff, Pro Se

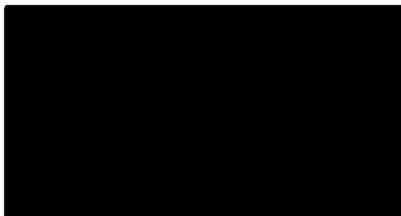


EXHIBIT INDEX

Exhibit A – EEOC Right-to-Sue Letter

Exhibit B – Written Reprimand dated August 6, 2025

Exhibit C – Plaintiff's Rebuttal to Written Reprimand dated August 6, 2025

Exhibit D – Timeline of Events

Exhibit E – Email to Payroll Specialist Requesting Unpaid Bereavement Leave – July 15, 2025

Exhibit F - August 13, 2025 HR Letter on Medical Leave

EXHIBIT A

EEOC Notice of Right to Sue



U.S. EQUAL EMPLOYMENT OPPORTUNITY COMMISSION

Miami District Office
100 SE 2nd St, Suite 1500
Miami, FL 33131
(800) 669-4000
Website: www.eeoc.gov

DETERMINATION AND NOTICE OF RIGHTS

(This Notice replaces EEOC FORMS 161, 161-A & 161-B)

Issued On: 08/14/2025

To: Ms. DEBRA E. NELSON

Charge No: 510-2025-08373

EEOC Representative and email: RODNEY MOZARD
INVESTIGATOR
RODNEY.MOZARD@EEOC.GOV

DETERMINATION AND NOTICE OF RIGHTS

The EEOC issues the following determination: The EEOC will not proceed further with its investigation and makes no determination about whether further investigation would establish violations of the statute. This does not mean the claims have no merit. This determination does not certify that the respondent is in compliance with the statutes. The EEOC makes no finding as to the merits of any other issues that might be construed as having been raised by this charge.

NOTICE OF YOUR RIGHT TO SUE

This is official notice that the EEOC has dismissed your charge and has issued you notice of your right to sue the respondent(s) on this charge. If you choose to file a lawsuit against the respondent(s) on this charge under federal law in federal or state court, **your lawsuit must be filed WITHIN 90 DAYS of your receipt of EEOC's official notice of dismissal.** You should keep a record of the date you received the EEOC's official notice of dismissal. Your right to sue based on this charge will be lost if you do not file a lawsuit in court within 90 days. (The time limit for filing a lawsuit based on a claim under state law may be different.)

If you file a lawsuit based on this charge, please sign-in to the EEOC Public Portal and upload the court complaint to charge 510-2025-08373

On behalf of the Commission,

Digitally Signed By: Evangeline Hawthorne
08/14/2025

Evangeline Hawthorne
Director

Cc:

Janice Hughes

Amentum

7701 USS Enterprise BUILDING 1429

Milton, FL 32570

NA NA

NAS WHITING FIELD

BUILDING 1429 BUILDING 1429

MILTON, FL 32570

Please retain this Notice for your records.

Enclosure with EEOC Notice of Closure and Rights (05/25)

**INFORMATION RELATED TO FILING SUIT
UNDER THE LAWS ENFORCED BY THE EEOC**

(This information relates to filing suit in Federal or State court under Federal law. If you also plan to sue claiming violations of State law, please be aware that time limits may be shorter and other provisions of State law may be different than those described below.)

IMPORTANT TIME LIMITS – 90 DAYS TO FILE A LAWSUIT

If you choose to file a lawsuit against the respondent(s) named in the charge of discrimination, you must file a complaint in court **within 90 days of the date you receive EEOC's official notice of dismissal**. You should **keep a record of the date you received EEOC's official notice of dismissal**. Once this 90-day period has passed, your right to sue based on the charge referred to in this Notice will be lost. If you intend to consult an attorney, you should do so promptly. Give your attorney a copy of this Notice, and the record of your receiving EEOC's official notice of dismissal (email or envelope).

If your lawsuit includes a claim under the Equal Pay Act (EPA), you must file your complaint in court within 2 years (3 years for willful violations) of the date you did not receive equal pay. This time limit for filing an EPA lawsuit is separate from the 90-day filing period under Title VII, the ADA, GINA, the ADEA, or the PWFA referred to above. Therefore, if you also plan to sue under Title VII, the ADA, GINA, the ADEA, or the PWFA, in addition to suing on the EPA claim, your lawsuit must be filed within 90 days of your receipt of EEOC's official notice of dismissal and within the 2- or 3-year EPA period.

Your lawsuit may be filed in U.S. District Court or a State court of competent jurisdiction. Whether you file in Federal or State court is a matter for you to decide after talking to your attorney. You must file a "complaint" that contains a short statement of the facts of your case which shows that you are entitled to relief. Filing this Notice is not enough. For more information about filing a lawsuit, go to <https://www.eeoc.gov/employees/lawsuit.cfm>.

ATTORNEY REPRESENTATION

For information about locating an attorney to represent you, go to:
<https://www.eeoc.gov/employees/lawsuit.cfm>.

In very limited circumstances, a U.S. District Court may appoint an attorney to represent individuals who demonstrate that they are financially unable to afford an attorney.

HOW TO REQUEST YOUR CHARGE FILE AND 90-DAY TIME LIMIT FOR REQUESTS

There are two ways to request a charge file: 1) a Freedom of Information Act (FOIA) request or 2) a "Section 83" request. You may request your charge file under either or both procedures. EEOC can generally respond to Section 83 requests more promptly than FOIA requests.

Since a lawsuit must be filed within 90 days of EEOC's official notice of dismissal, please submit your FOIA and/or Section 83 request for the charge file promptly to allow sufficient time for EEOC to respond and for your review.

To make a FOIA request for your charge file, submit your request online at <https://eeoc.arkcase.com/foia/portal/login> (this is the preferred method). You may also submit a

Enclosure with EEOC Notice of Closure and Rights (05/25)

FOIA request for your charge file by U.S. Mail by submitting a signed, written request identifying your request as a "FOIA Request" for Charge Number 510-2025-08373 to the District Director at Evangeline Hawthorne, 100 SE 2nd St Suite 1500, Miami, FL 33131.

To make a Section 83 request for your charge file, submit a signed written request stating it is a "Section 83 Request" for Charge Number 510-2025-08373 to the District Director at Evangeline Hawthorne, 100 SE 2nd St Suite 1500, Miami, FL 33131.

You may request the charge file up to 90 days after receiving EEOC's official notice of dismissal. After the 90 days have passed, you may request the charge file only if you have filed a lawsuit in court and provide a copy of the court complaint to EEOC.

For more information on submitting FOIA requests, go to <https://www.eeoc.gov/eeoc/foia/index.cfm>.

For more information on submitted Section 83 requests, go to <https://www.eeoc.gov/foia/section-83-disclosure-information-charge-files>.

EXHIBIT B

Written Reprimand on August 6, 2025



The intranet-posted version of this guidance is the document of record.

WRITTEN REPRIMAND

August 6, 2025

To: Debra Nelson

Employee ID: 621036

From: Dakota Thomas, Aircraft Maintenance Supervisor

Subject: WRITTEN REPRIMAND

CC: Personnel File

Current Violation(s) / Cause:

The purpose of this letter is to issue you a written reprimand for violation of Offense 5c *Failing to report absence within ½ hour of start of work shift*, Offense 19 *Insubordination* and Offense 26 *Deliberate falsifications of facts to management or any other form of dishonesty*.

Circumstances of Violations:

On 30 JUL 2025, you requested leave through supervisor Elias Velasquez for 31 JUL 2025 and 1 AUG 2025 via form "HR-313 Leaves of Absence – Paid and Unpaid". Upon receipt, Mr. Velasquez inquired as to whether there would be issues taking the leave since you did not have the required amount of SKA/VAC time to cover the time off. You advised Velasquez that you spoke with upstairs, and that there were no issues with taking the leave. Velasquez refused to approve the leave and contacted the HR and Business Manager on 30 JUL 2025 to verify the status of your leave. The Business Manager and HR did inform your supervisor Elias Velasquez that you did not speak to them nor was your leave of absence approved by them. Therefore, the leave was never approved by a supervisor, and you were not authorized to take the leave that was taken.

On 30 July 25, you spoke with the Site payroll administrator and advised her that you had an approved leave chit when you inquired how to code your timesheet since you did not have enough leave to cover the time requested. Payroll advised you how to code the time with the information given. The information you provided to payroll was a false statement in that you did not have an approved leave chit. Your timecard has since been amended to reflect the appropriate code of Unpaid/Unauthorized Time.

You did not follow the established leave policy process. You did not follow the directions of your supervisor which was for you to speak with HR or the Business Manager to discuss your request for leave or a Leave of Absence. You proceeded to take off work on 31 JUL 2025 and 1 AUG 2025 without authorization and coded your timecard as Unpaid/Authorized Time.

You are reminded that Amentum and the Union has established procedures, pertaining to taking time off from work: Vacation, Sick Time, Personal Leave of Absence, Short Term Disability, Federal Medical Leave of absence. This information is provided to you in the Union CBA Handbook and the Amentum Paid and Unpaid leave policy (located on the company intranet).

This letter will remain in your personnel file for six months from the date of issuance, in accordance with our Collective Bargaining Agreement Bridge Agreement, expiring March 31, 2026.

Employee Acknowledgment

My signature on this form indicates that I have discussed this concern identified above with my manager, received a copy of this written warning, and acknowledge its contents. It does not necessarily indicate that I agree with its contents. I understand that immediate, sustained improvement is required in the area(s) expressed above, or further disciplinary action, up to and

Internal Information
Ref: HR-314 Disciplinary Process

HR-314-F-2 Written Warning HR-314-F-2 | Version No. 2
Issue Date: 1/31/2021 | Review/Revision Date: 4/23/2024


amentum

The intranet-posted version of this guidance is the document of record.

including termination of employment, may occur. I further acknowledge that this document will be included in my personnel file.

Employee Signature

Date

8/6/2025

Manager Signature

Date

8/6/2025

If applicable:

James Cornley

Witness Name

Witness Signature

8-6-25

Date

WRITTEN REPRIMAND

Should you wish to do so, you may respond to this Written Reprimand in writing within five (5) days of receipt of this letter. If you do so, your response will be included with this Written Reprimand and added to your personnel file.

I refuse to sign because I was never told to go to HR. I talked to Tionne and I was told that I had to charge my time if I didn't have enough time to use ^{the} unauthorized code. At no time was I told to go to HR. I disagree with this write up which is retaliatory.

EXHIBIT C

Written Rebuttal for August 6, 2025 Writeup

Written Rebuttal – August 6, 2025

Disciplinary Write-up

August 7, 2025

This is my formal rebuttal to the August 6, 2025 write-up for 'unauthorized time'.

In July, I took bereavement leave July 10, 11, 14 & 15 and unpaid leave July 16, 17, 18 and 21 leave coordinated with Payroll Specialist, Tionne only. HR approval was never required or mentioned.

The sudden change in protocol and write-up without attempt to contact me shows retaliation. I request the reprimand be removed or this rebuttal be attached.

Sincerely,
Debra Nelson

EXHIBIT D

Chronological Timeline Events

EXHIBIT D**Timeline of Events**

May 28 – Plaintiff was called into a meeting in the equipment room at 2:25pm 5 minutes before Plaintiff's shift ended. Plaintiff told Elias that Plaintiff's shift was ending and he could talk to Yusef who was standing right next to him. In the meeting was the second shift Maintenance Supervisor, Elias Valasquez, Union Representative, Jimmy Murphy; first shift Maintenance Supervisor, Dakota Thomas, NDI Technician, Yusef Abdul-Jami and myself. In the meeting Plaintiff was being questioned about the contents of locker 2, Plaintiff said that Yusef is standing right there and pointed at him. Elias said "you don't have to have an attitude and you don't need this fucking shit in here". Plaintiff told Elias you don't need to curse at me and he had no right to be cursing me. The other men that were in the room said nothing. Elias dismissed what Plaintiff said and continued to ask me if Plaintiff needed to keep certain parts in the locker. Plaintiff continued to say Yusef is right here why aren't you asking him because he was responsible for locker 2. Elias said that we could keep the spare parts in the Tool Room. Plaintiff said that's not how NDI works. We usually keep spare parts along with our other equipment. Elias then said that we can just keep these extra probes in the Tool Room and Dakota agreed. Plaintiff then said "I would consult with the NDI Level III if Plaintiff were you". Elias said I'm not doing nothing we just going to put those probes in the Tool Room and Dakota agreed. After the meeting Plaintiff immediately went over to HR to report the Supervisor cursing at her.

May 29 – In a meeting with James Carnley, Chief Union Steward; Janice Hughes, HR Generalist; Heather Gunn, Business Manager; Clarence Xander, Site Manager; Dakota Thomas, Maintenance Supervisor and myself. In the meeting we discussed Elias cursing at me. Plaintiff discussed the locker issue and Yusef did not keep up with the process control in the NDI program. Plaintiff told them that process control has not been in compliance since the previous NDI Technician left. Plaintiff told them that airplanes inspected without the process control being done prior to the inspection could get the company fined. Plaintiff was told by Clarence Xander that Plaintiff was not to text Yusef anymore. Plaintiff was told by Clarence that Plaintiff's response to Yusef was aggressive, and Plaintiff was told she had an attitude. Plaintiff asked the Site Manager, Clarence Xander, about the incident where Supervisor Elias Valasquez cursed at Plaintiff during a meeting. Site Manager Xander responded, "you cursed too." Plaintiff stated that did not happen and asked what she was accused of saying. Xander replied, "it doesn't matter." Plaintiff repeated that she was being accused of doing something she did not do and again asked what she was accused of saying. Xander again stated, "it doesn't matter." There was absolutely no discipline or accountability for Yusef not pulling his share of the

workload. Plaintiff left that meeting knowing that management was covering for Yusef and somehow, Plaintiff was made the bad guy in this situation. Plaintiff was not supported in that meeting and in the workload situation.

May 30 – My leave of absence began. On May 30th Plaintiff tried to log in to Costpoint to sign Plaintiff's time for the week. Plaintiff was locked out and Payroll already went home. Plaintiff would have to contact Payroll on Monday to get Plaintiff's password reset.

June 2 – Plaintiff contacted the Payroll Generalist, Tionne Thomas to reset Plaintiff's password. When Plaintiff went into Plaintiff's time Plaintiff noticed times were moved around. Plaintiff asked Tionne about it and she said that Plaintiff had PTO. Plaintiff said we talked about this last week and you said Plaintiff didn't have any PTO left. Tionne said Heather Gunn signed Plaintiff's time on Friday May 30th. Plaintiff told Tionne she didn't have to do that and Plaintiff didn't give her permission to go into Plaintiff's time. Heather moved Plaintiff's hours around from the previous week. Plaintiff asked Tionne to reopen Plaintiff's time so Plaintiff could put the correct hours where they belong. Plaintiff believe Heather was trying to set me up for stealing time.

July 2 - When Plaintiff returned from Plaintiff's leave of absence Plaintiff had a meeting with James Carnley, Chief Union Steward; Heather Gunn, Business Manager; Clarence Xander, Site Manager; Dakota Thomas, Supervisor and myself. In this meeting Clarence stated he didn't know Plaintiff was coming back on that day. Plaintiff clearly stated in Plaintiff's leave of absence paperwork and to Corporate that Plaintiff would be coming back on July 2nd after all discrepancies within the NDI program were corrected. When Plaintiff got back the broken probe was still in the kit and there were a few other items that were not in compliance. In the meeting Plaintiff asked Clarence about the statement that Plaintiff cursed at a Supervisor and Clarence said "it didn't matter". Plaintiff asked him what was the issue and why wouldn't he tell me what Plaintiff was accused of saying and Clarence said again "it didn't matter". Plaintiff told Clarence that was defamation. Clarence then said he wanted to end the meeting.

July 24 – Plaintiff did a 6300 hour eddy current inspection on drain holes on aircraft 166037 over in the Phase hangar. Plaintiff signed the job off after the inspection was completed in the Phase hangar.

July 25 – Plaintiff messaged Dakota letting him know Plaintiff was running late. Dakota then asked what time Plaintiff thought Plaintiff would get to work and Plaintiff said about 2:55pm. Dakota then said that we will meet on Tuesday July 29th at 2pm. Plaintiff asked what this meeting was about and Dakota said about a work order that was signed off and he had some questions. Plaintiff asked what work order and Dakota said it would be discussed on Tuesday.

When Plaintiff got to work, Plaintiff logged on to see if Plaintiff had any work in the queue. Plaintiff noticed the aircraft and job Plaintiff did the night before was still in the queue. When Plaintiff opened up the job the corrective action was blank. So Plaintiff went to Phase to see what the issue was. Plaintiff spoke with the 2nd shift Phase Lead, Tom Beauman and asked what was up with aircraft 166037 and Tom said that the aircraft was not ready for the 6300 hour inspection Plaintiff did the night before because it wasn't defueled. Tom said there were panels that also needed to be removed, and Plaintiff was supposed to inspect the drain holes from the inside after all that was done. Plaintiff said Plaintiff didn't realize that and Plaintiff asked when it would be ready. Tom said that wouldn't happen that night because there was other maintenance that needed to be completed. Tom said that when he saw that Plaintiff had signed it off he realized that was a mistake because he did that same thing last month (June) with the other NDI Tech Yusef. Tom said when the aircraft is ready they would call NDI. Plaintiff went back to Hangar 100 and told Shop Lead 100-200, Phillip Sorrow the status on aircraft 166037.

July 29 – At the 2pm meeting in attendance was first shift Maintenance Supervisor, Dakota Thomas; Business Manager, Heather Gunn; HR Generalist, Ja'nicé Hughes; Elias Valasquez, 2nd shift Maintenance Supervisor; Union Chief Steward, James Carnley and me. So, Dakota started the meeting asking what happened with the 6300 hour inspection. Plaintiff said, "so this is what we're doing"? Plaintiff said the same thing happened last month with Yusef. Did you call the Business Manager and the HR Representative for him? Dakota said he didn't know anything about that. Plaintiff repeated what the 2nd shift Phase Lead Tom Beauman told her. Dakota said "well I'll have to look into that". Dakota didn't sound like he believed me. Which has been a consistent pattern since May when Plaintiff reported Yusef for not helping with the locker. That meeting was supposed to be Dakota's opportunity to write me up to try and create a paper trail. Since he didn't know that Plaintiff knew that Yusef did the same thing he was unable to accomplish that goal.

July 30, 2025 – Plaintiff was assigned to perform an eddy current inspection and discovered that the cable was broken. After testing multiple probes and troubleshooting, Plaintiff confirmed the cable was defective. Plaintiff returned to the shop to obtain a replacement but found none available. Plaintiff went to the Tool Room, as supervision had stated on May 28, 2025, that spare parts would be kept there. The Tool Room staff informed Plaintiff that they did not have any NDI equipment, including cables. Without a replacement cable, Plaintiff was unable to perform any eddy current inspections.

Later, Plaintiff received a nick prop inspection for aircraft 166182 and performed a fluorescent penetrant inspection, identifying several defects on the propellers. Plaintiff documented the defects in the corrective action section of OOMA and showed the findings to Supervisor Elias Valasquez. Valasquez initially believed the propellers were going to be painted; Plaintiff advised that the defects needed blending and that the

propellers were not ready for paint. Valasquez later stated the propellers would be reinspected on day shift. Plaintiff believes the propellers were not reinspected and that the indications were not repaired, as no corresponding maintenance records exist. Yusef Abdul-Jami's name appeared on Plaintiff's corrective action entry and on another sign-off for the same job. Abdul-Jami later placed a note in the turnover log on July 31st stating the cable worked when he used it and after Plaintiff used it on July 30, 2025.

August 4 – Plaintiff returned to work and saw that Yusef put a note in the turnover log stating that the cable that Plaintiff said was broken worked before Plaintiff used it and it worked after Plaintiff used it. This is false because Plaintiff checked that cable and used other probes to verify the issue. Even with other probes the cable still did not work. Plaintiff 100% stand behind what Plaintiff said, the cable was broken. Yusef in order to deflect to get the attention off of himself and try to discredit me, tells Supervision the cable worked, and they believed him. Yusef had a bag with cables in them that Plaintiff personally saw. After Plaintiff reported him for not helping with the locker, he said he didn't know what happened to the bag.

When Plaintiff brought the issue up with Elias and told him that Yusef switched that cable out with the broken one and was trying to discredit me. Elias immediately jumped to Yusef's defense, which is not uncommon, and said that the cable worked. Plaintiff told Elias that the cable did not work and that Yusef switched it out. Elias then says to me that Plaintiff have an attitude, he has to talk to me like I'm a child, then he says go ahead and do the report cause I'm going to look stupid and everybody has a problem with me. Plaintiff told Elias that he is starting to piss me off because y'all always act like Plaintiff don't know what I'm talking about. This is the incredibly hostile environment that Plaintiff am subjected to. Everything Plaintiff say is dismissed if it's contrary to Plaintiff's male counterpart. The gender-based characterizations used to minimize Plaintiff's concerns all of this creates a hostile work environment.

August 5 - After repeatedly asking since May 30, Plaintiff was finally informed by Corporate that Plaintiff had been accused of saying, "Who the fuck do you think you are." Plaintiff categorically deny making this statement. While Plaintiff may curse in casual conversation, Plaintiff have never cursed at a supervisor or used language in that tone or phrasing. That statement is not consistent with how Plaintiff speak — it does not reflect Plaintiff's vernacular, and Plaintiff would never address management in such a manner. The phrasing sounds more like something a Caucasian person would say, Plaintiff am Black and the language attributed to me feels intentionally mischaracterized. Despite Plaintiff's repeated efforts to clarify this issue, Corporate refused to tell me who made the accusation, leaving me defenseless against a false and discriminatory claim. This concealment has added to Plaintiff's emotional distress and demonstrates continued bad faith by management.

August 6 - Dakota Thomas along with the HR Rep Janice Hughes and the Business Manager Heather Gunn issued me a written reprimand after the 2 complaints that Plaintiff filed on August 4th & 5th. The reprimand was for an unauthorized absence. Plaintiff requested time off for a court date on July 31st. Plaintiff told Plaintiff's Supervisor Elias Valasquez on July 29th that Plaintiff didn't have enough time to be off for both days and Elias said I'll approve the time that you have off but you will have to go upstairs. Plaintiff went on July 30th and talked to the Payroll Specialist Tionne. Plaintiff told her that Plaintiff needed to be off Thursday and Friday July 31st and August 1st but Plaintiff didn't have enough time. She said Plaintiff would need to use Plaintiff's personal time and then use unauthorized leave. Plaintiff said ok because I've done it many times before. However, in the meeting on August 6th Plaintiff was told that Elias did not approve Plaintiff's leave and that Plaintiff told Tionne Plaintiff's time was authorized. At no point did anyone tell me that Plaintiff had to talk to the HR Rep to take unauthorized time off because Plaintiff didn't have to do it before. If Plaintiff's leave was not approved as Elias said then why was that not communicated to me verbally, by text or email. Plaintiff was being set up to fabricate a write up.

EXHIBIT E

**Email to Payroll Specialist Requesting Unpaid
Bereavement Leave – July 15, 2025**



Re: PTO

From Debra Nelson <[REDACTED]>
Date Tue 7/15/2025 4:02 PM
To Thomas, Tionne <Tionne.Thomas@amentum.com>
Cc Lisenby, Krista <Krista.Lisenby@amentum.com>; Hughes, Janice <Janice.Hughes@amentum.com>; Gunn, Heather <Heather.Gunn@amentum.com>

Thanks

Get Outlook for Android

From: Thomas, Tionne <Tionne.Thomas@amentum.com>
Sent: Tuesday, July 15, 2025 3:23:55 PM
To: [REDACTED] <[REDACTED]>
Cc: Lisenby, Krista <Krista.Lisenby@amentum.com>; Hughes, Janice <Janice.Hughes@amentum.com>; Gunn, Heather <Heather.Gunn@amentum.com>
Subject: RE: PTO

Good Afternoon,

You will use the UAP code for the additional days. I will put the code below.

FR01.OTHRLV.UAPXX

Thank you,
Tionne Thomas
Office Administrator Senior
Office: 850.484.6257
Cell: 850.736.3666
Tionne.Thomas@amentum.com
7701 USS Enterprise, Milton, FL 32570
amentum.com



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From: Gunn, Heather <Heather.Gunn@amentum.com>
Sent: Tuesday, July 15, 2025 1:21 PM
To: denelson62@outlook.com
Cc: Thomas, Tionne <Tionne.Thomas@amentum.com>; Lisenby, Krista <Krista.Lisenby@amentum.com>; Hughes,

Janice <Janice.Hughes@amentum.com>

Subject: FW: PTO

Good Afternoon Ms. Nelson,

Your request for the additional four (4) days of LWO is **approved**. I am sorry to hear about your loss. Please take this time to grieve. Should you need anything, please let us know.

Respectfully,

Heather Gunn

Business Manager I

Aviation Solutions | Critical Missions

O: 850-484-6266

C: 850-736-5147

7701 USS Enterprise, Milton, FL 32570



From: Xander, Clarence <Clarence.Xander@amentum.com>

Sent: Tuesday, July 15, 2025 1:14 PM

To: Thomas, Tionne <Tionne.Thomas@amentum.com>

Cc: Gunn, Heather <Heather.Gunn@amentum.com>; Hughes, Janice <Janice.Hughes@amentum.com>

Subject: RE: PTO

Tionne,

Approved.

Clarence

From: Thomas, Tionne <Tionne.Thomas@amentum.com>

Sent: Tuesday, July 15, 2025 8:51 AM

To: Xander, Clarence <Clarence.Xander@amentum.com>

Cc: Gunn, Heather <Heather.Gunn@amentum.com>; Hughes, Janice <Janice.Hughes@amentum.com>

Subject: FW: PTO

Clarence,

Please see below. Debra Nelson is out on Bereavement leave for her paternal grandmother and would like you use the additional days of LWO.

Thank you,

Tionne Thomas

Office Administrator Senior

Office: 850.484.6257

Cell: 850.736.3666

Tionne.Thomas@amentum.com

7701 USS Enterprise, Milton, FL 32570

amentum.com



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From: Debra Nelson < >
Sent: Tuesday, July 15, 2025 8:27 AM
To: Thomas, Tionne <Tionne.Thomas@amentum.com>
Subject: [EXTERNAL] Re: PTO

(Good morning. I would like to take additional unpaid bereavement leave and return on July 22, 2025. So that would be 4 more days)

Get Outlook for iOS

From: Thomas, Tionne <Tionne.Thomas@amentum.com>
Sent: Monday, July 14, 2025 11:04:33 AM
To: Debra Nelson < >
Subject: RE: PTO

Received, thank you!

Thank you,
Tionne Thomas
Office Administrator Senior
Office: 850.484.6257
Cell: 850.736.3666
Tionne.Thomas@amentum.com
7701 USS Enterprise, Milton, FL 32570
amentum.com



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From: Debra Nelson < >
Sent: Monday, July 14, 2025 9:48 AM
To: Thomas, Tionne <Tionne.Thomas@amentum.com>
Subject: [EXTERNAL] Re: PTO

Attached is a copy of my grandmother's obituary. That is my father's (David Lee Williams) mother

EXHIBIT F

August 13, 2025 HR Letter on Medical Leave



Date: August 13, 2025
To: Debra Nelson
From: Janice Hughes
Subject: Request for Medical Leave of Absence

Per our discussion, you have requested a medical leave of absence. In accordance with the Company's Medical Leave Policy HR-316, employees are required to contact The Hartford to file a Family and Medical Leave and/or STD claim.

I've attached a copy of the Medical Leave procedure and Amentum FMLA & Disability Claim flyer for reference. To file a claim, you will need to contact The Hartford at 877-877-6043 or complete an online form via [HTTPS://ABILITYADVANTAGE.THEHARTFORD.COM](https://ABILITYADVANTAGE.THEHARTFORD.COM).

Amentum has received notification that The Hartford has created a Short-Term Disability claim and a Leave of Absence claim for you, Debra Nelson, as of 08/06/2025. The Hartford will contact your treating physician to obtain the needed information to either approve or deny your request for Short-term Disability and a medical leave of absence.

If your claim is approved, you will be required to provide periodic updates to me on your return-to-work status.

If your claim is denied, the time that you have taken during the approval process will be changed from authorized leave to unauthorized leave. You will be required to return to work immediately. If you choose not to return to work, disciplinary actions may be taken.

You are tentatively approved for a Medical Leave of Absence beginning Friday, August 8, 2025, pending receipt of the final determination on your claim by The Hartford.

Upon receipt of the determination from The Hartford, I will be sending you additional communication outlining your leave status. Should you have any questions, please do not hesitate to contact me at Janice.Hughes@amentum.com or 850-484-6250

Regards,

Janice
Hughes

Digitally signed by Janice Hughes
DN: cn=Janice Hughes,
o=Amentum F44, ou=Critical Mission
email=Janice.Hughes@amentum.com
Date: 2025.08.13 11:54:46 -0500

Janice Hughes
Human Resource Generalist